HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Isolation

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers isolation: making plant and equipment safe to work on - process isolation by valves, spades and blinds, electrical isolation at an isolator with locks and tags, proving dead, circuit earths on a high voltage system, and locating underground services before a dig. It appears in method statements and task risk assessments for every permit type, most of all for confined space entry, electrical isolation and excavation.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- equipment isolated and drained, by double block and bleed or by spades and blinds
- the isolator where a supply is isolated, locked off and tagged, with the fuses withdrawn
- personal locks on the isolation or on its lock box
- a test that proves the equipment dead at the point of work, and circuit earths on a high voltage system
- buried cables and pipes located from the drawings and with a cable locator before digging

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the request's isolation answers: proved dead, personal locks and circuit earths, or services located for a dig.

2 Read each sentence of this kind for the isolation point, the locks, the test and the earths.

3 Check a voltage the sentence gives against the request's system voltage.

4 Note a sentence saying the equipment is not proved dead, a lock is missing or the services are not located.

5 Check a process isolation for an entry is positive: spades or blinds, not valves alone.

4. Requirements it bears on

Isolation bears on the proved dead, personal locks and circuit earths requirements of the electrical isolation standard, and on the services located requirement of the excavation standard.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

When a statement describes an isolation other than the request's - another voltage, a lock not yet applied, services not yet located - the reviewer notes it for the Area Authority and keeps the request's answers, which still decide the requirements.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority for the isolation certificate with its isolation points, the proving dead test, the personal lock register and, on a high voltage system, the circuit earths record; for a dig, the services drawings and the cable locator survey.

7. Telling it apart

Making equipment safe to work on is isolation; fitting the work around other jobs and the running plant - a linked permit, a permit live nearby, the control room's agreement - is simultaneous operations, which the Simultaneous Operations guide covers. "The agitator drive is isolated under the linked permit" is isolation; "the control room must agree before work starts" is simultaneous operations.